FRENCH REVOLUTION AND NAPOLEON

OLD-REGIME PRESSURE SYSTEM → JUNE-JULY 1789 RUPTURE → REVOLUTIONARY PHASE LADDER → RIGHTS CLAIM AND BOUNDARY → JACOBIN EMERGENCY TRIANGLE → SOCIAL COALITION MATRIX

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW · ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 OLD-REGIME PRESSURE SYSTEM

OLD-REGIME PRESSURE SYSTEM · LEGAL PRIVILEGE · CLERGY AND NOBILITY HOLD EXEMPTIONS · FISCAL BREAKDOWN · MONARCHY SUMMONS ESTATES-GENERAL · BREAD STRESS · URBAN AND PEASANT MOBILISATION · GRIEVANCE BECOMES A LEGITIMACY CHALLENGE

CORE CLAIM

- LEGAL PRIVILEGE → clergy and nobility hold exemptions
- FISCAL BREAKDOWN → monarchy summons Estates-General
- BREAD STRESS → urban and peasant mobilisation

MECHANISM

- ENLIGHTENMENT → grievance becomes a legitimacy challenge
- MUST REMEMBER: Estates-General, National Assembly, Bastille, August decrees and Rights
- Declaration belong to 1789; republic and regicide, Terror, Directory, Brumaire (1799),

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- Empire (1804) and Waterloo (1815) form later distinct stages.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Empire (1804) and Waterloo (1815) form later distinct stages.

01

STAGE 01 JUNE-JULY 1789 RUPTURE

JUNE-JULY 1789 RUPTURE · 17 JUNE · THIRD ESTATE BECOMES NATIONAL ASSEMBLY · 20 JUNE · TENNIS COURT OATH COMMITS CONSTITUTION-MAKING · 14 JULY · BASTILLE TURNS CONSTITUTIONAL REVOLT INTO MASS SYMBOL · RIGHTS AND LEGAL EQUALITY PROCLAIMED

17 JUNE → Third Estate becomes National Assembly → 20 JUNE → Tennis Court Oath commits constitution-making → 14 JULY → Bastille turns constitutional revolt into mass symbol → AUGUST → rights and legal equality proclaimed

CORE CLAIM

- 17 JUNE → Third Estate becomes National Assembly
- 20 JUNE → Tennis Court Oath commits constitution-making

MECHANISM

- 14 JULY → Bastille turns constitutional revolt into mass symbol
- AUGUST → rights and legal equality proclaimed

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 17 JUNE → Third Estate becomes National Assembly
- 20 JUNE → Tennis Court Oath commits constitution-making

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 14 JULY → Bastille turns constitutional revolt into mass symbol.

02

STAGE 02 REVOLUTIONARY PHASE LADDER

REVOLUTIONARY PHASE LADDER · NATIONAL ASSEMBLY AND CONSTITUTIONAL MONARCHY · REPUBLIC, WAR, JACOBINS AND TERROR · DIRECTORY AND CIVILIAN INSTABILITY · NAPOLEONIC CONSOLIDATION AND EMPIRE

1789-91 → National Assembly and constitutional monarchy → 1792-94 → republic, war, Jacobins and Terror → 1795-99 → Directory and civilian instability → 1799-1815 → Napoleonic consolidation and empire

CORE CLAIM

- 1789-91 → National Assembly and constitutional monarchy
- 1792-94 → republic, war, Jacobins and Terror

MECHANISM

- 1795-99 → Directory and civilian instability
- 1799-1815 → Napoleonic consolidation and empire

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 1789-91 → National Assembly and constitutional monarchy
- 1792-94 → republic, war, Jacobins and Terror

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1795-99 → Directory and civilian instability; 1799-1815 → Napoleonic consolidation and empire.

03

STAGE 03 RIGHTS CLAIM AND BOUNDARY

RIGHTS CLAIM AND BOUNDARY · EQUALITY BEFORE LAW AND CITIZENSHIP · NO IMMEDIATE UNIVERSAL SUFFRAGE · ACTION WITHOUT EQUAL POLITICAL CITIZENSHIP · SLAVERY EXPOSES UNIVERSALISM'S CONTRADICTION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CLAIM → equality before law and citizenship	WOMEN → action without equal political citizenship	CLAIM → equality before law and citizenship
BOUNDARY → no immediate universal suffrage	COLONIES → slavery exposes universalism's contradiction	BOUNDARY → no immediate universal suffrage

CORE CLAIM

- CLAIM → equality before law and citizenship
- BOUNDARY → no immediate universal suffrage

MECHANISM

- WOMEN → action without equal political citizenship
- COLONIES → slavery exposes universalism's contradiction

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CLAIM → equality before law and citizenship
- BOUNDARY → no immediate universal suffrage

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WOMEN → action without equal political citizenship; COLONIES → slavery exposes universalism's contradiction.

04

STAGE 04 JACOBIN EMERGENCY TRIANGLE

JACOBIN EMERGENCY TRIANGLE · EXTERNAL INVASION AND NATIONAL DEFENCE · FEAR OF INTERNAL BETRAYAL · NARROWING POLITICAL COMPETITION · DEMOCRATIC CLAIMS JOINED TO COERCIVE VIOLENCE

WAR → external invasion and national defence

COUNTER-REVOLUTION → fear of internal betrayal → FACTION → narrowing political competition → TERROR → democratic claims joined to coercive violence

CORE CLAIM

- WAR → external invasion and national defence
- COUNTER-REVOLUTION → fear of internal betrayal

MECHANISM

- FACTION → narrowing political competition
- TERROR → democratic claims joined to coercive violence

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- WAR → external invasion and national defence
- COUNTER-REVOLUTION → fear of internal betrayal

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TERROR → democratic claims joined to coercive violence.

05

STAGE 05 SOCIAL COALITION MATRIX

SOCIAL COALITION MATRIX · OFFICE, PROPERTY AND LEGAL EQUALITY · END DUES, RENTS AND FEUDAL BURDENS · URBAN CROWD · BREAD, VOICE AND SOCIAL EQUALITY · ORDER, MERIT AND LATER NAPOLEONIC AUTHORITY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
BOURGEOISIE → office, property and legal equality	URBAN CROWD → bread, voice and social equality	BOURGEOISIE → office, property and legal equality
PEASANTRY → end dues, rents and feudal burdens	ARMY → order, merit and later Napoleonic authority	PEASANTRY → end dues, rents and feudal burdens

CORE CLAIM

- BOURGEOISIE → office, property and legal equality
- PEASANTRY → end dues, rents and feudal burdens

MECHANISM

- URBAN CROWD → bread, voice and social equality
- ARMY → order, merit and later Napoleonic authority

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- BOURGEOISIE → office, property and legal equality
- PEASANTRY → end dues, rents and feudal burdens

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ARMY → order, merit and later Napoleonic authority.

06

STAGE 06 NAPOLEON'S INHERITANCE LEDGER

NAPOLEON'S INHERITANCE LEDGER · ANTI-FEUDAL REFORM AND LEGAL RATIONALISATION · CAREERS OPEN TO TALENT AND CODIFIED LAW · REPUBLIC, FREE POLITICS AND POPULAR SOVEREIGNTY · REFORM THROUGH CONQUEST AND OCCUPATION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
PRESERVED → anti-feudal reform and legal rationalisation	CURTAILED → republic, free politics and popular sovereignty	PRESERVED → anti-feudal reform and legal rationalisation
EXPANDED → careers open to talent and codified law	EXPORTED → reform through conquest and occupation	EXPANDED → careers open to talent and codified law

CORE CLAIM

- PRESERVED → anti-feudal reform and legal rationalisation
- EXPANDED → careers open to talent and codified law

MECHANISM

- CURTAILED → republic, free politics and popular sovereignty
- EXPORTED → reform through conquest and occupation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- PRESERVED → anti-feudal reform and legal rationalisation
- EXPANDED → careers open to talent and codified law

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CURTAILED → republic, free politics and popular sovereignty.

07

STAGE 07 ABOLITION AND REVERSAL

ABOLITION AND REVERSAL · REVOLUTIONARY PHASE · SLAVERY ABOLISHED IN FRENCH COLONIES · ABOLITION REVERSED · RIGHTS PROBLEM · COLONY TESTS UNIVERSAL CITIZENSHIP · FINAL FRENCH ABOLITION

REVOLUTIONARY PHASE → slavery abolished in French colonies → NAPOLEON → abolition reversed → RIGHTS PROBLEM → colony tests universal citizenship → 1848 → final French abolition

CORE CLAIM

- REVOLUTIONARY PHASE → slavery abolished in French colonies
- NAPOLEON → abolition reversed

MECHANISM

- RIGHTS PROBLEM → colony tests universal citizenship
- 1848 → final French abolition

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- REVOLUTIONARY PHASE → slavery abolished in French colonies
- NAPOLEON → abolition reversed

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: REVOLUTIONARY PHASE → slavery abolished in French colonies.

08

STAGE 08 NATION AND CITIZENSHIP

NATION AND CITIZENSHIP · SUBJECT OF KING · INHERITED OBEDIENCE · BEARER OF PUBLIC RIGHTS AND DUTIES · PEOPLE BECOMES SOURCE OF SOVEREIGNTY · NATIONALISM AND CONSTITUTIONALISM GAIN A NEW GRAMMAR

SUBJECT OF KING → inherited obedience → CITIZEN → bearer of public rights and duties → NATION → people becomes source of sovereignty → LEGACY → nationalism and constitutionalism gain a new grammar

CORE CLAIM

- SUBJECT OF KING → inherited obedience
- CITIZEN → bearer of public rights and duties

MECHANISM

- NATION → people becomes source of sovereignty
- LEGACY → nationalism and constitutionalism gain a new grammar

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- SUBJECT OF KING → inherited obedience
- CITIZEN → bearer of public rights and duties

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LEGACY → nationalism and constitutionalism gain a new grammar.

09

STAGE 09 WHY MODERATE SETTLEMENT FAILED

WHY MODERATE SETTLEMENT FAILED · 1791 CONSTITUTION · LEGAL OLD REGIME BROKEN · FISCAL, RELIGIOUS AND WAR CRISES REMAIN · POPULAR CLASSES DEMAND DEEPER CHANGE · MONARCHY FALLS AND REPUBLIC BEGINS · CLOSE DISTINCTION · FISCAL BREAKDOWN, PRIVILEGE AND SUBSISTENCE CRISIS WERE STRUCTURAL CONDITIONS

1791 CONSTITUTION → legal old regime broken → UNRESOLVED → fiscal, religious and war crises remain → MOBILISATION → popular classes demand deeper change → OUTCOME → monarchy falls and republic begins → CLOSE DISTINCTION: Fiscal breakdown, privilege and subsistence crisis were structural conditions

CORE CLAIM

- 1791 CONSTITUTION → legal old regime broken
- UNRESOLVED → fiscal, religious and war crises remain

MECHANISM

- MOBILISATION → popular classes demand deeper change
- OUTCOME → monarchy falls and republic begins

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Fiscal breakdown, privilege and subsistence crisis were structural conditions
- ministerial failure and the 1789 political confrontation were triggers, while crowds, peasants and assemblies supplied agency.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Fiscal breakdown, privilege and subsistence crisis were structural conditions; ministerial failure and the 1789 political confrontation were triggers, while crowds, peasants and assemblies supplied agency.

10

STAGE 10 NON-LINEAR REVOLUTIONARY LEGACY

NON-LINEAR REVOLUTIONARY LEGACY · RIGHTS AND LEGAL RUPTURE · TERROR TESTS LIBERTY · EMPIRE KEEPS SOCIAL GAINS, ENDS REPUBLIC · 1815 ONWARD · RESTORATION FACES RENEWED NATIONALISM · EVIDENCE LIMIT · NAPOLEONIC LAW AND ADMINISTRATIVE RATIONALISATION SPREAD SELECTED REVOLUTIONARY GAINS

1789 → rights and legal rupture → 1793-94 → Terror tests liberty → 1799-1815 → empire keeps social gains, ends republic → 1815 ONWARD → restoration faces renewed nationalism → EVIDENCE LIMIT: Napoleonic law and administrative rationalisation spread selected revolutionary gains, but

CORE CLAIM

- 1789 → rights and legal rupture
- 1793-94 → Terror tests liberty

MECHANISM

- 1799-1815 → empire keeps social gains, ends republic
- 1815 ONWARD → restoration faces renewed nationalism

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Napoleonic law and administrative rationalisation spread selected revolutionary gains, but
- censorship, dynastic empire and war block a simple liberator or revolutionary-fulfilment verdict.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EVIDENCE LIMIT: Napoleonic law and administrative rationalisation spread selected revolutionary gains, but censorship, dynastic empire and war block a simple liberator or revolutionary-fulfilment verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Napoleonic law and administrative rationalisation spread selected revolutionary gains, but censorship, dynastic empire and war block a simple liberator or revolutionary-fulfilment verdict.

11

STAGE 11 FRENCH REVOLUTION ANSWER SPINE

FRENCH REVOLUTION ANSWER SPINE · PRIVILEGE + FISCAL CRISIS + BREAD + IDEAS · 1789 RUPTURE · SOCIAL CONSOLIDATION + POLITICAL REVERSAL · LEGITIMACY CHANGED MORE FULLY THAN SOCIAL EQUALITY

CAUSE → privilege + fiscal crisis + bread + ideas → COURSE → 1789 rupture → republic → Terror → Directory → NAPOLEON → social consolidation + political reversal → VERDICT → legitimacy changed more fully than social equality

CORE CLAIM

- CAUSE → privilege + fiscal crisis + bread + ideas
- COURSE → 1789 rupture → republic → Terror → Directory

MECHANISM

- NAPOLEON → social consolidation + political reversal
- VERDICT → legitimacy changed more fully than social equality

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CAUSE → privilege + fiscal crisis + bread + ideas
- COURSE → 1789 rupture → republic → Terror → Directory

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → legitimacy changed more fully than social equality.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · OLD NCERT IS ESPECIALLY USEFUL BECAUSE IT SHOWS THAT · ON ELITE THINKERS BUT ALSO ON WORKERS, ARTISANS, PEASANTS · THIS IS IMPORTANT IN MAINS ANSWERS · DO NOT WRITE THE EVENT AS IF PAMPHLETS ALONE · OLD NCERT STATES THAT THE JACOBINS BELIEVED IN DIRECT · IT ALSO NOTES THAT IN 14 MONTHS AROUND 17,000 · UNDER THE JACOBIN CONSTITUTION, OLD NCERT HIGHLIGHTS UNIVERSAL MALE

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Old NCERT is especially useful because it shows that the Revolution rested not only
- on elite thinkers but also on workers, artisans, peasants and the Paris crowd .
- CAUTION: This is important in mains answers: do not write the event as if pamphlets alone toppled the old regime.
- Old NCERT states that the Jacobins believed in direct democracy and, fearing danger to the Revolution, adopted harsh measures.

ADVANCED DEBATE

- It also notes that in 14 months around 17,000 people were tried and executed.
- Under the Jacobin constitution, old NCERT highlights universal male political rights, the right
- of insurrection, and the principle that government must provide work or livelihood.
- CAUTION: Therefore the Terror cannot be dismissed as mere madness

LEGACY / NUANCE

- nor can it be romanticised.
- It joined mass democracy, war emergency and coercive violence in one unstable package.
- CAUTION: Best formulation: Napoleon stabilised the social revolution while reversing much of its political republicanism.
- Old NCERT says the French Revolution inspired movements in almost every country of Europe and in South and Central America.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels